Set up controls in the Input Map

Digital Technologies · School computers

You will

- make actions, like `jump`, `move_left` and `move_right`
- give each action one or more keys
- use an action in your code

You need

- your Godot project open, with a script on a node (see the guide Add nodes and attach a script)
- optional: a sound node to test with (see the guide Add images and sounds)

Before you start

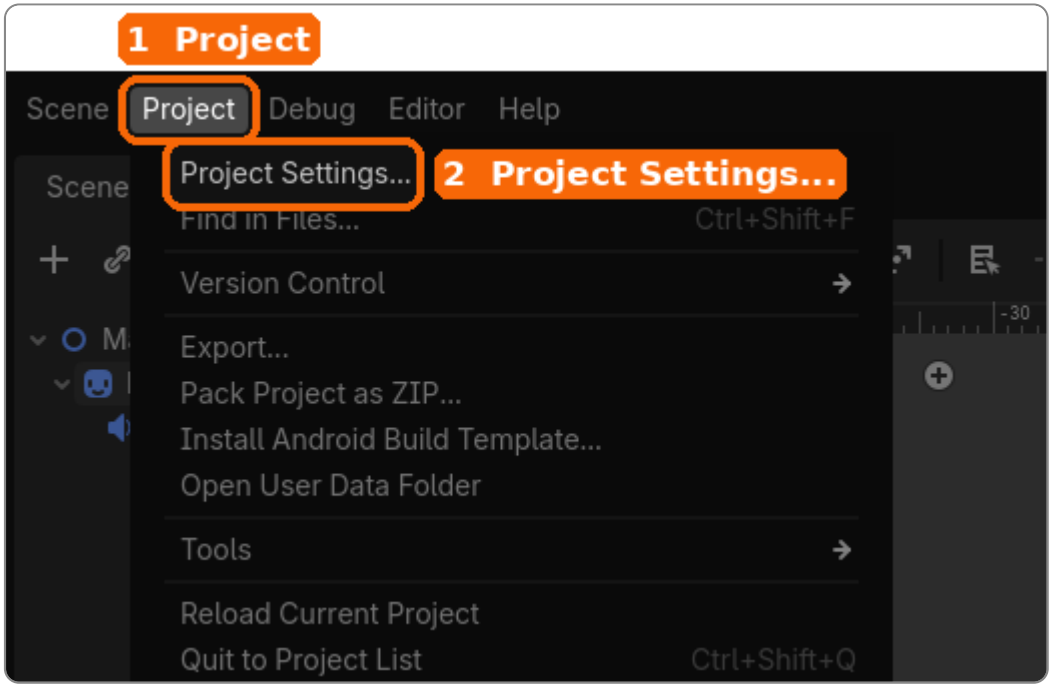
- An action is a name for something the player does. Your code uses the name, so you can change or add keys later without changing your code.
- Action names: lowercase, with underscores.

 Click here  Look here

1

Godot › Project menu

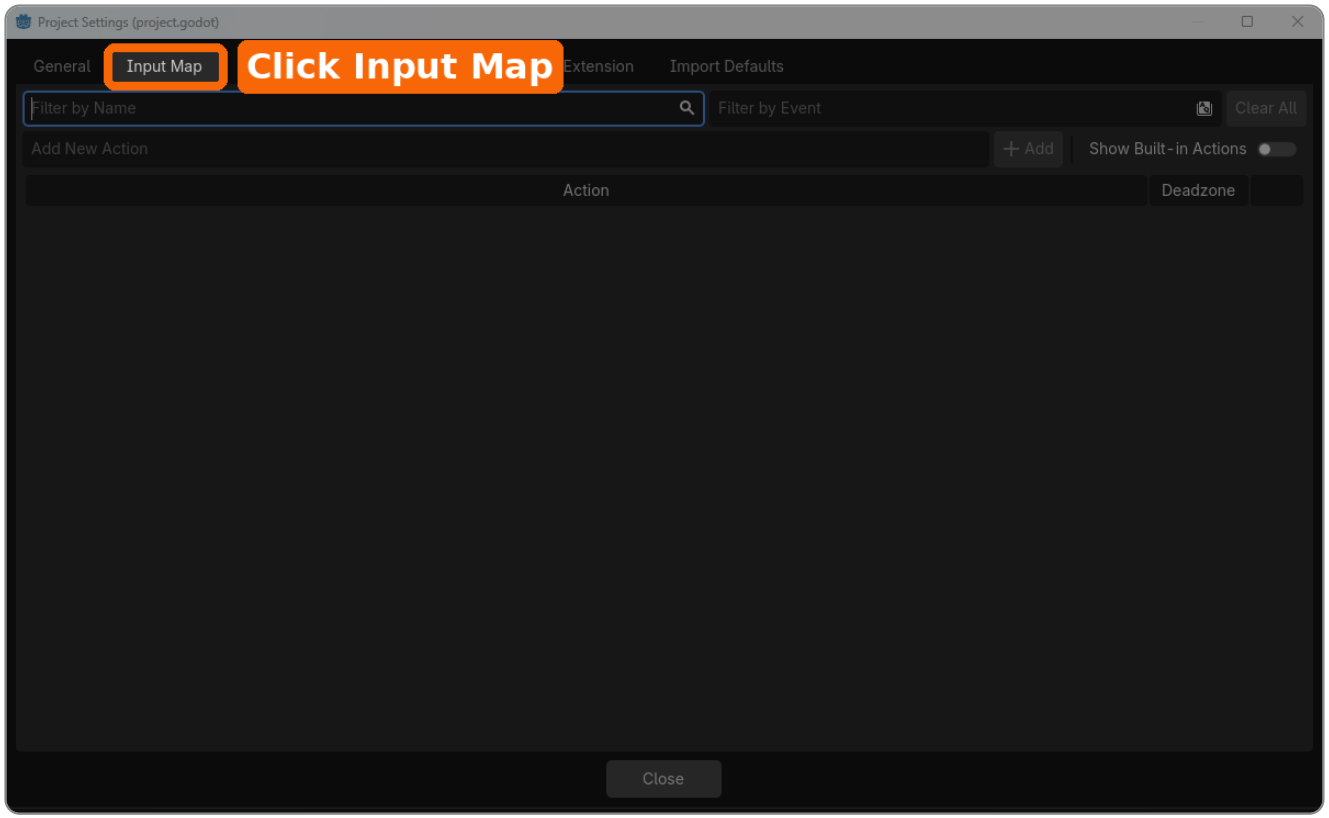
Click **Project** › **Project Settings...**



2

Godot › Project Settings

Click the **Input Map** tab.

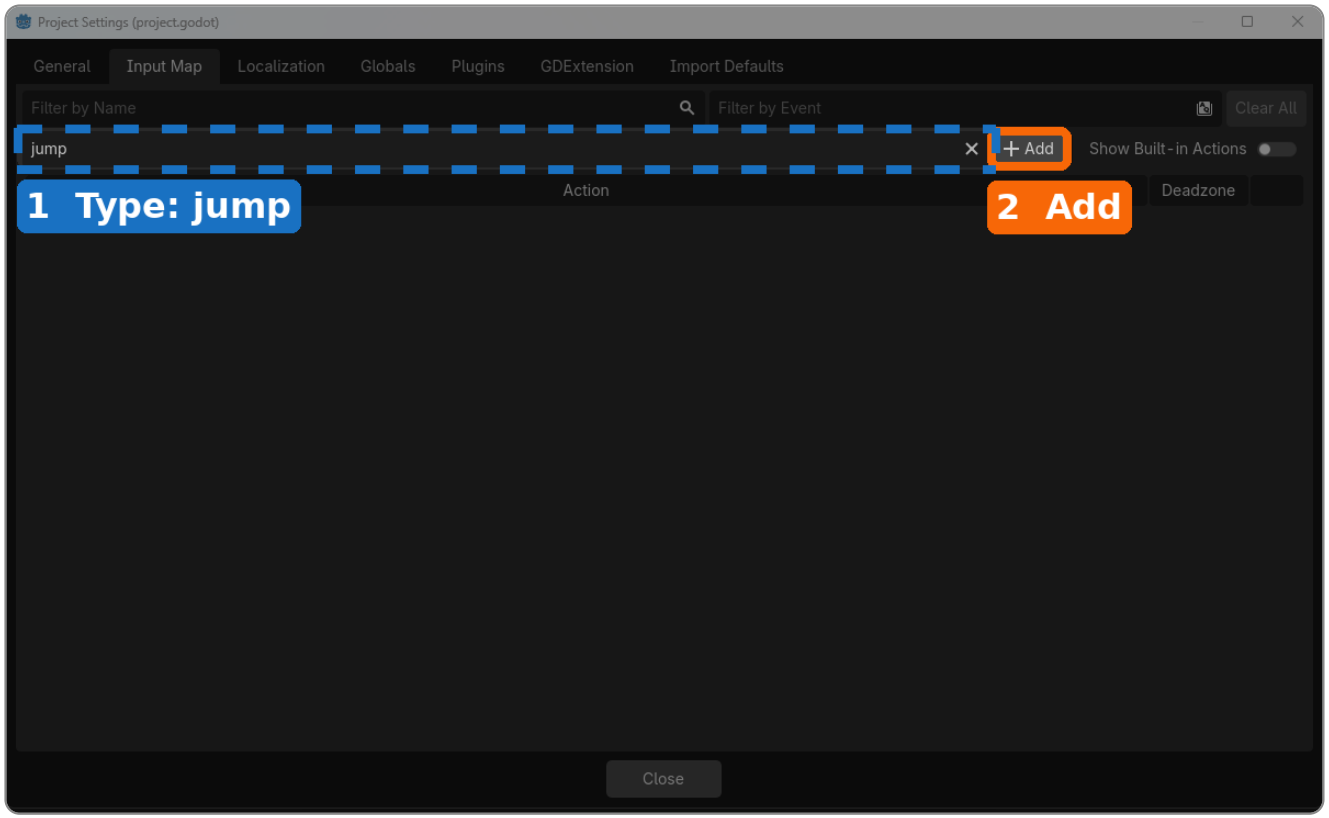


3

Godot › Project Settings › Input Map

In **Add New Action**, type `jump`.

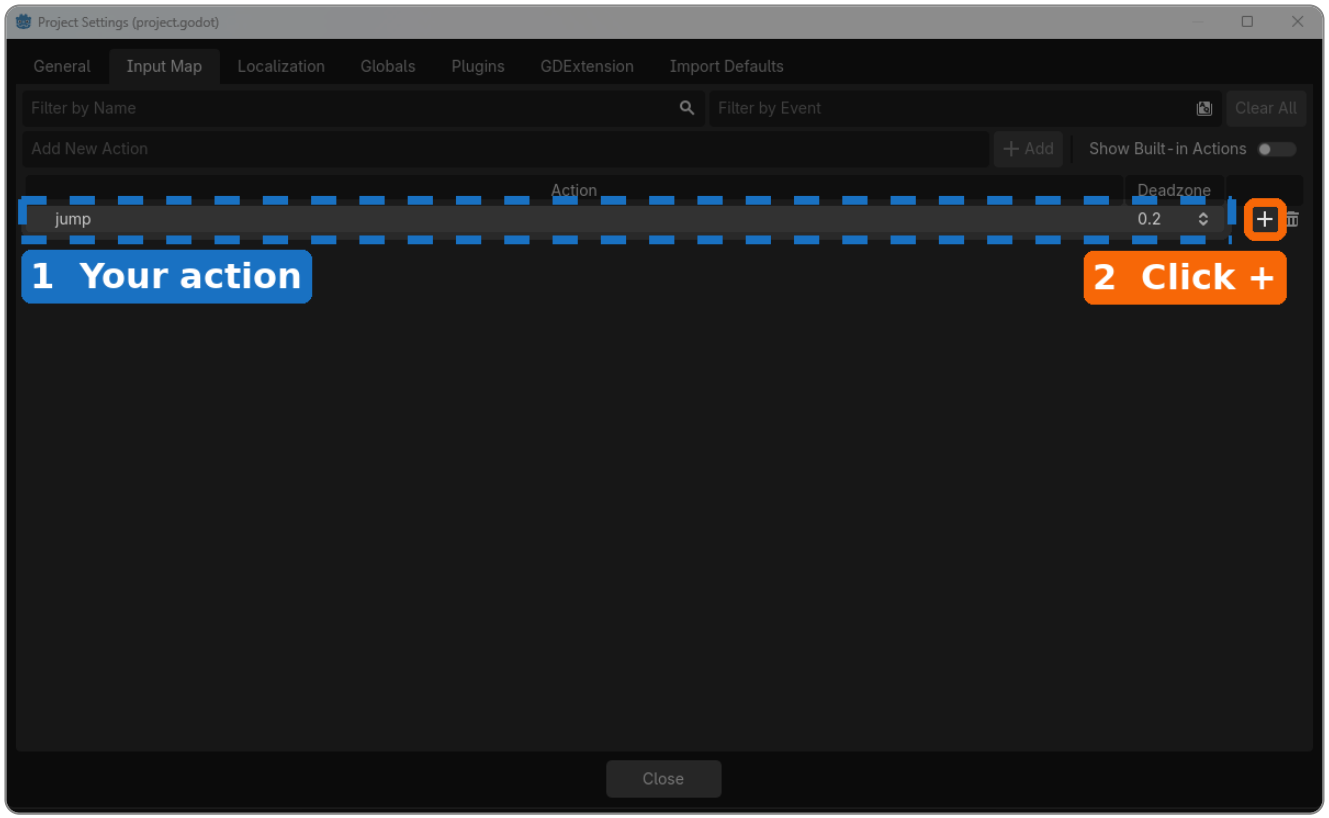
Click **Add** (or press `Enter`).



4

Godot › Project Settings › Input Map

Click **+** at the end of the `jump` row.

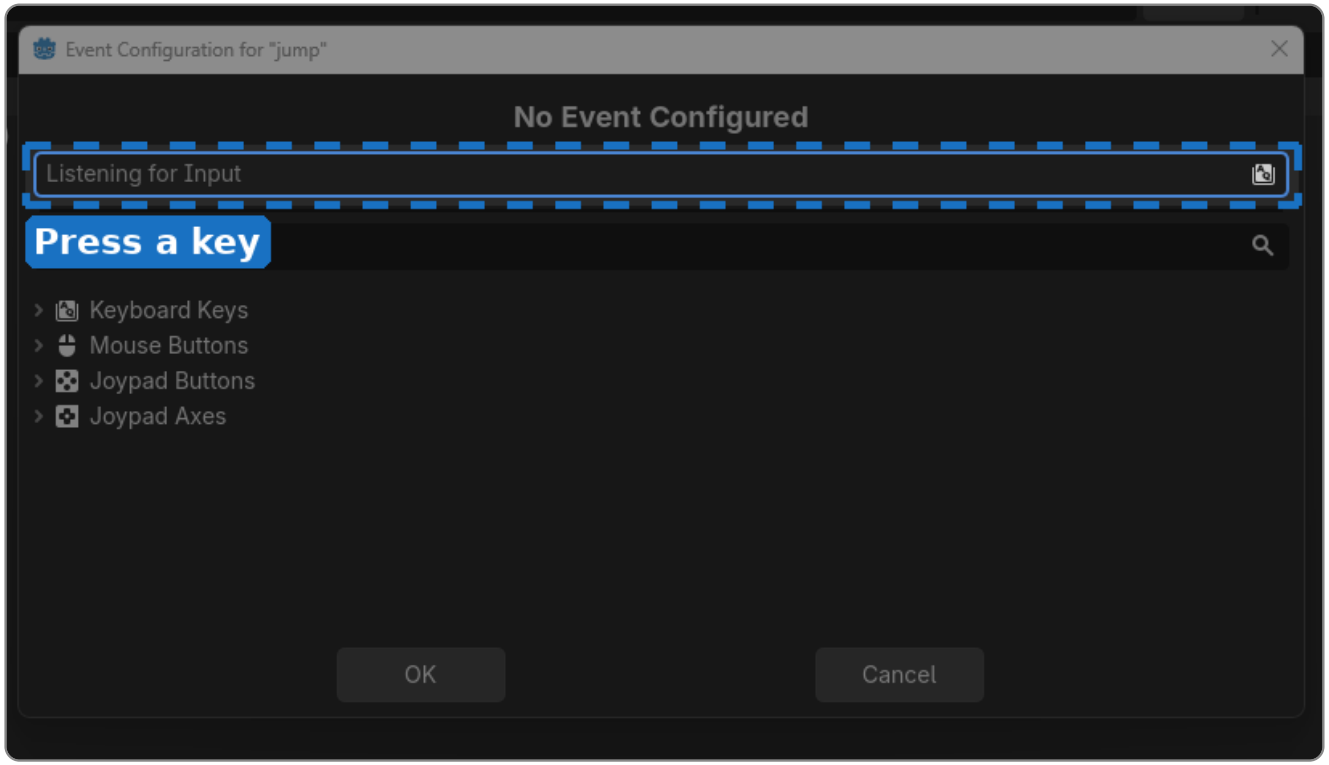


5

Godot › Event Configuration

Press the key you want, like Space.

The box is listening for a key, so just press it.

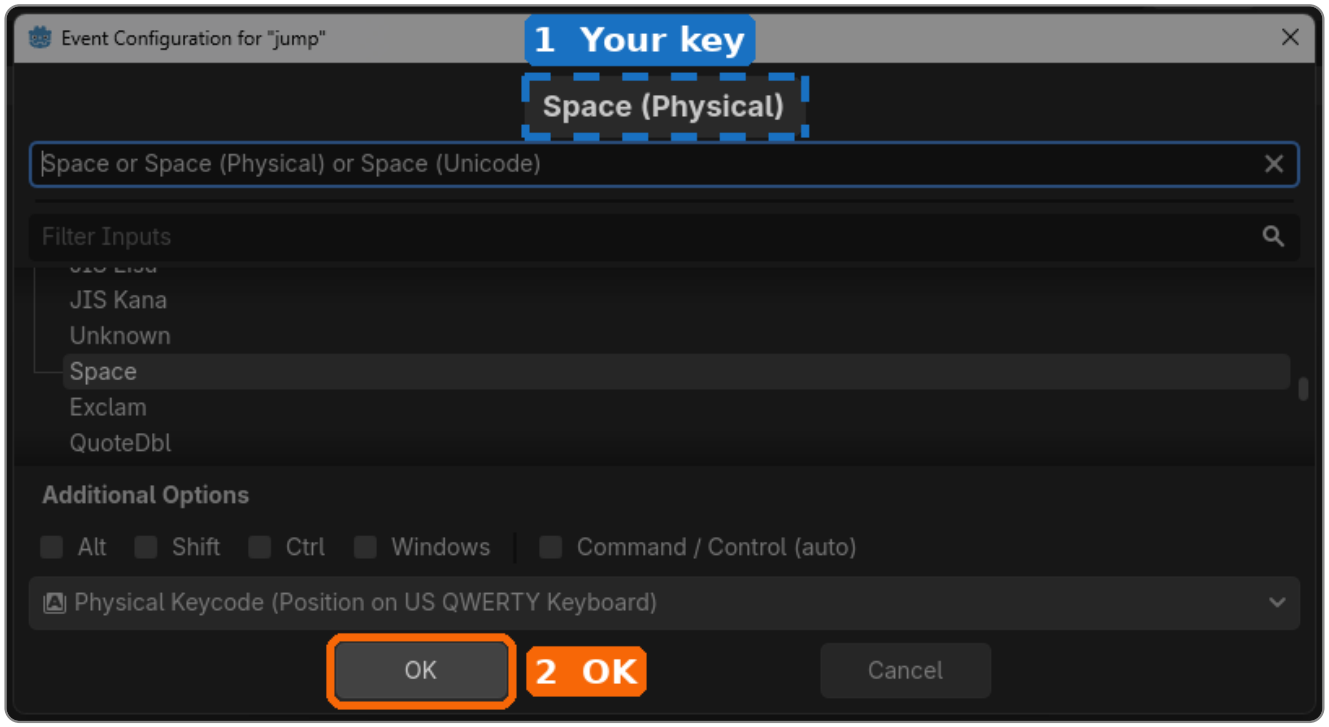


6

Godot › Event Configuration

Check it shows your key.

Click **OK**.

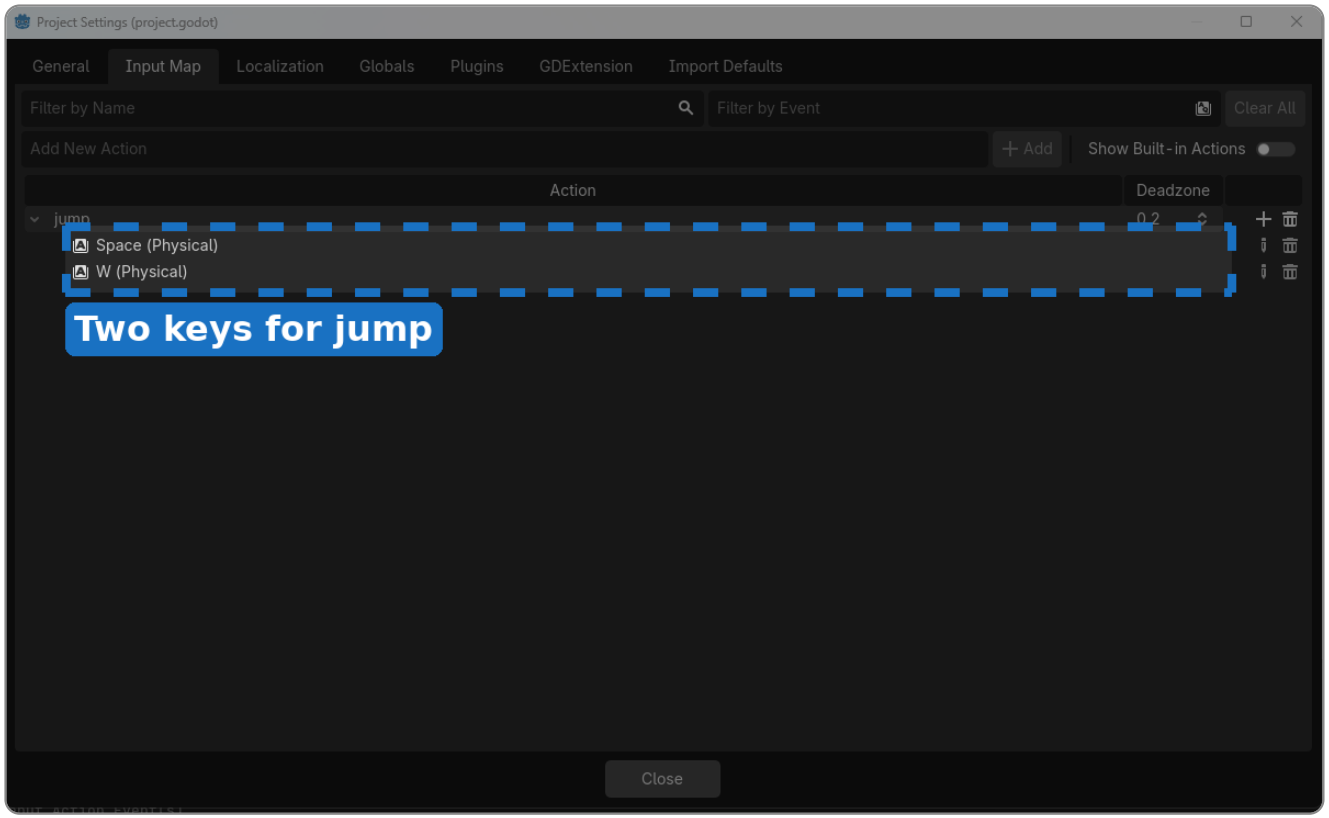


7

Godot › Project Settings › Input Map

Add a second key the same way: click **+**, press the key, click **OK**.

Two keys, like Space and W, give players a choice.



8

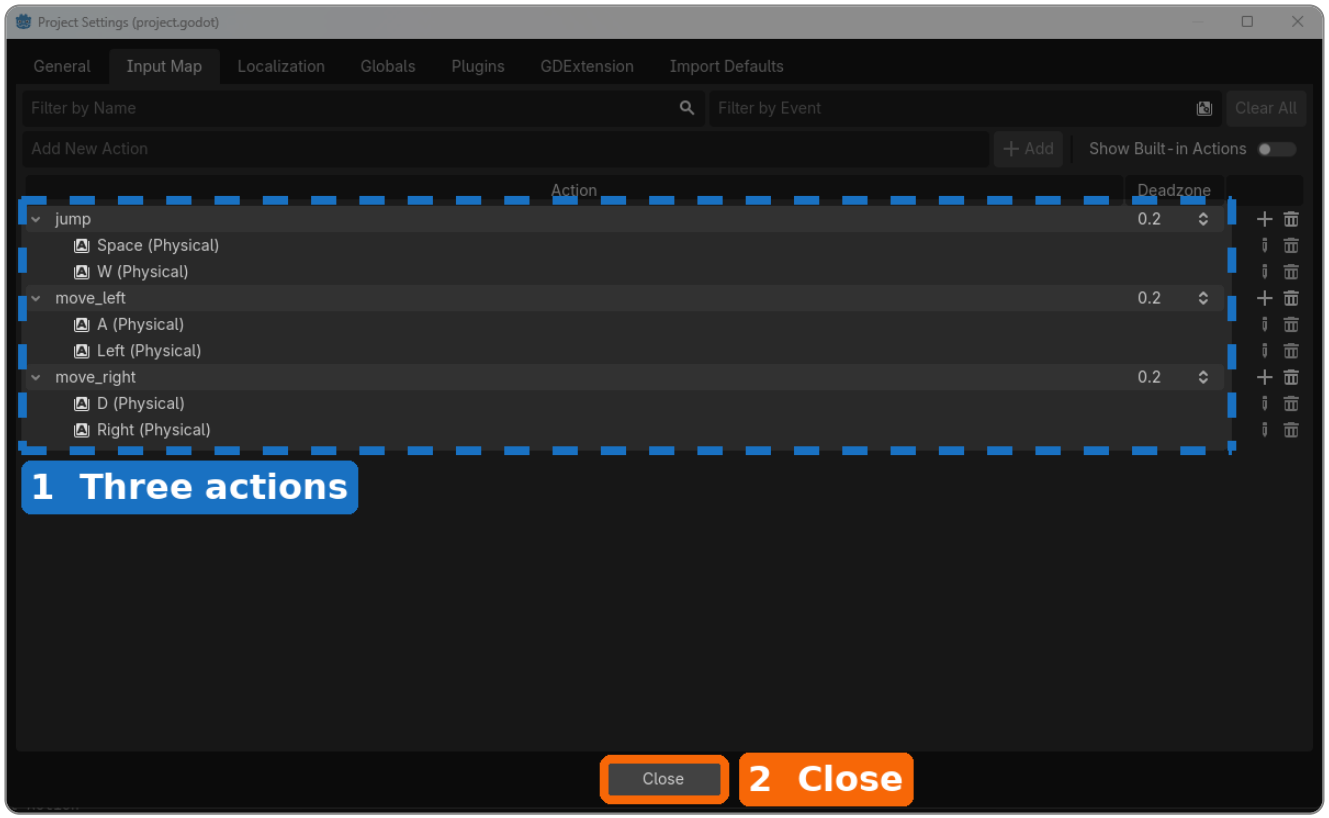
Godot › Project Settings › Input Map

Add `move_left` (A and Left arrow) and `move_right` (D and Right arrow) the same way.

Click **Close**.

> **Check:** each action has its keys under it.

If something goes wrong
Wrong key: click the bin next to it, then add the right one.



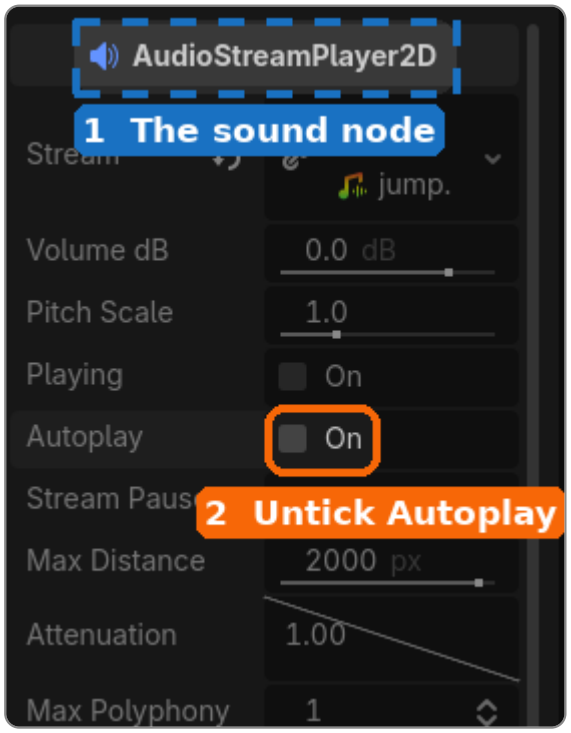
9

Godot › Inspector › only if you have a sound node

Testing with a sound? Click your **AudioStreamPlayer2D** node.

Untick **Autoplay**.

Now the sound only plays when your code tells it to. No sound node? Skip this step.



10

Godot › Script editor

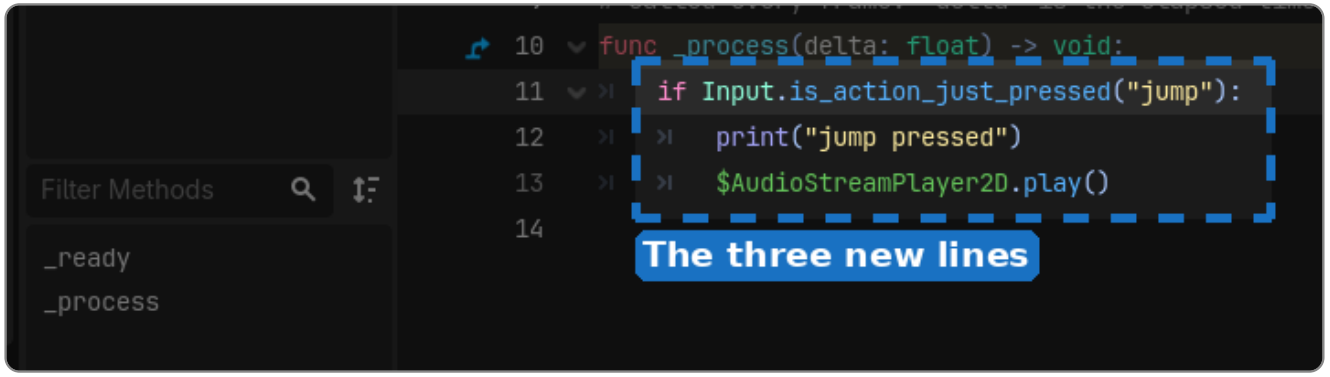
Open the script on your node.

Find `func _process` and replace `pass` so it looks like this:

```
func _process(delta: float) -> void:
→   if Input.is_action_just_pressed("jump"):
→   →   print("jump pressed")
→   →   $AudioStreamPlayer2D.play()
```

Press `Ctrl` + `S`.

Each arrow is one `Tab`. The name in quotes must match the Input Map exactly. No sound node? Leave out the last line.



If something goes wrong

Error about an action that doesn't exist: check the spelling and capitals of the name in quotes.

11

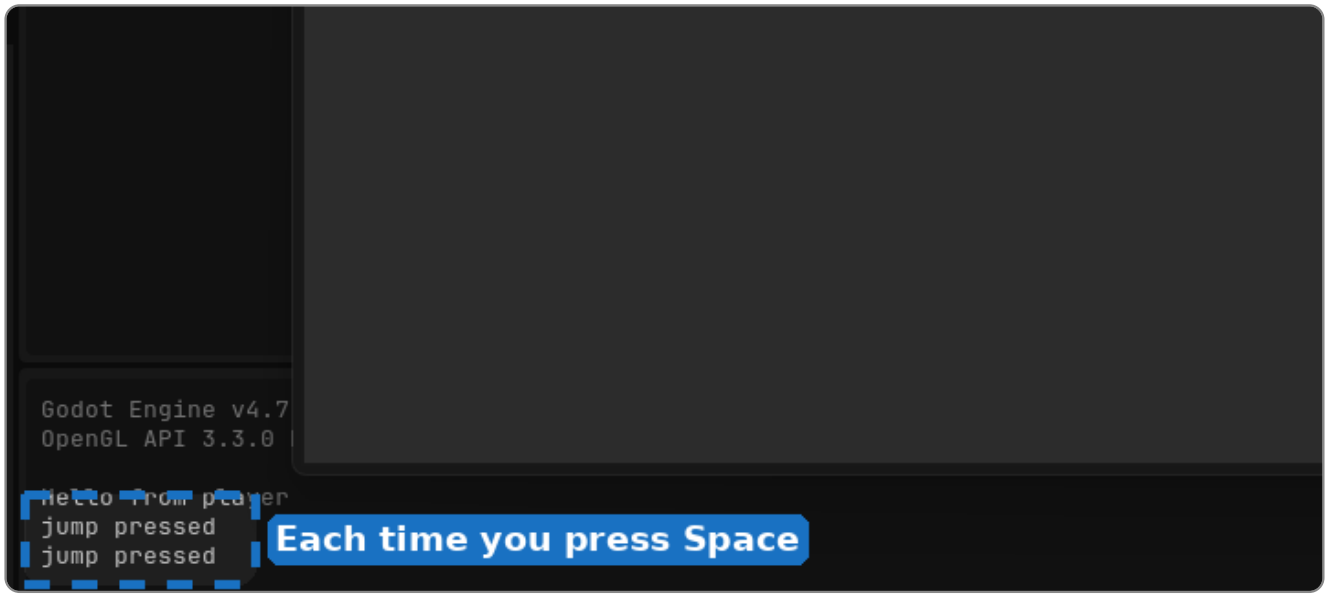
Godot › Your game window

Press F5.

Press Space a few times.

Press F8 to stop.

> **Check:** Output shows `jump pressed` each time, and you hear your sound if you added one.

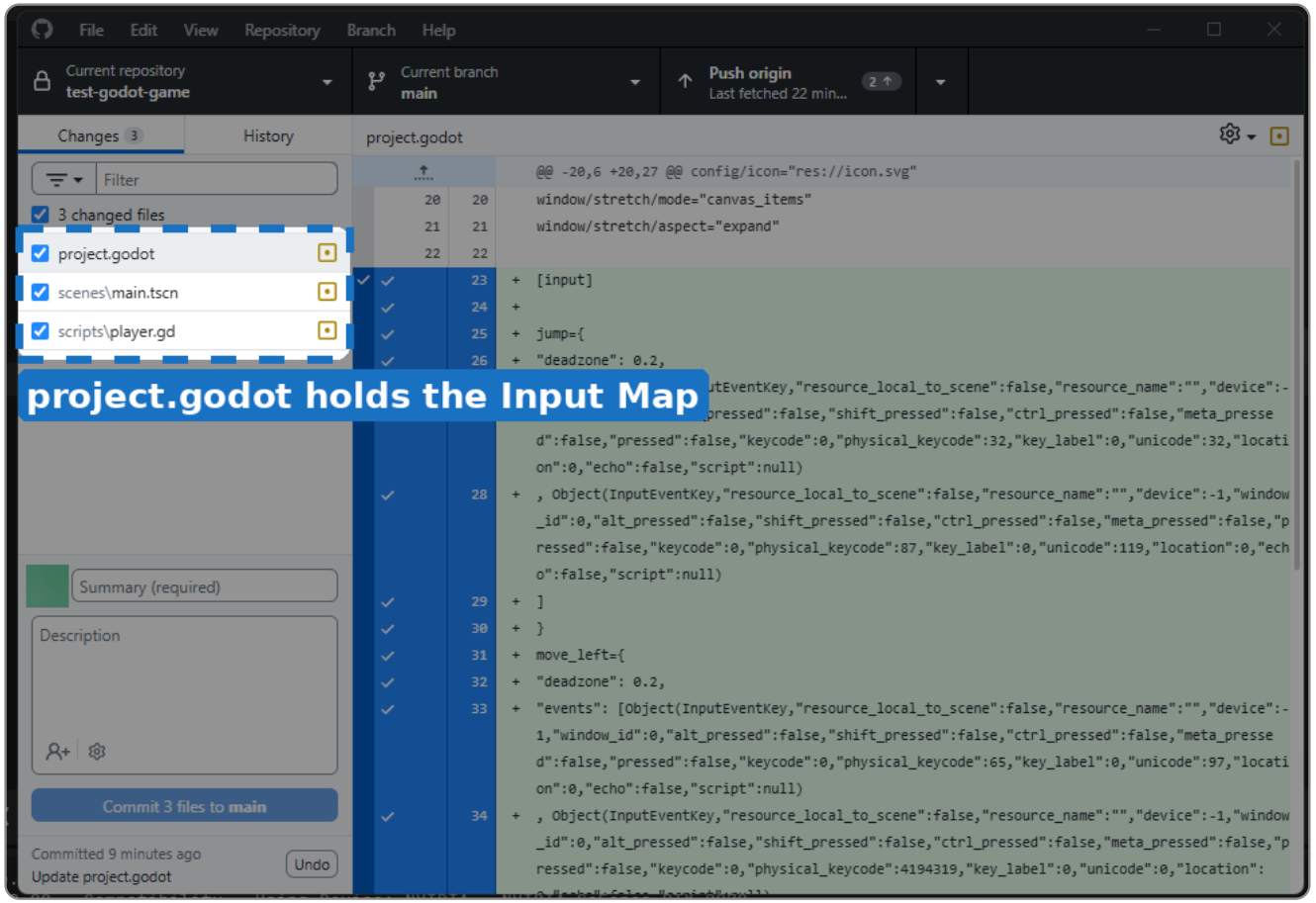


12

GitHub Desktop › Changes › if your project is on GitHub

Commit and push with GitHub Desktop, as usual.

Your Input Map is saved in `project.godot`, so it goes to GitHub with your project.



Actions, not keys

Use action names in your code, like

```
Input.is_action_pressed("move_left")
```

Change the keys in the Input Map, never in your code.

Pressed or held

`is_action_just_pressed` is true once per press, good for jumping. `is_action_pressed` is true the whole time the key is held, good for moving.

Checkpoint

- [ ] I can add an action and give it keys.
- [ ] I can use an action in my code.
- [ ] My code's action names match the Input Map exactly.